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**WHO'S IN, WHO'S OUT?** Karnataka chief minister Siddaramaiah with Deputy CM D.K. Shivakumar in Bengaluru, Mar. 5

THE NATION
KARNATAKA

# PITFALLS OF THE CASTE COUNT

THE **CONGRESS ENTHUSIASM FOR A CASTE CENSUS** NOTWITHSTANDING, THE SIDDARAMAIAH GOVERNMENT'S TABLING OF THE KARNATAKA SOCIAL AND EDUCATIONAL SURVEY 2015 IS NOW A POLITICAL HOT POTATO

By Ajay Sukumaran

A long-gestating item on Karnataka chief minister Siddaramaiah's policy wishlist finally made it to the agenda of a cabinet meeting on April 17. The consternation among the Congress's own legislators, the aggravated tones in community debates in the state, perhaps beyond, all that had been building up. For, on the table was the 306-page report of the Karnataka Social and Educational Survey (KSES) 2015—the first caste census of recent times, predating that